Job Applier: put it online and use it

This guide has two parts:

- **Part A** gets you your own private web address for the app (about 15 minutes, free, done once).
- **Part B** walks through using the app, with a screenshot of every step.

Every screenshot is from the real app running in the same container that you will deploy. The person in them is a made-up test candidate ("Asha Testcandidate"). In Part B steps 5 to 9 the jobs come from the app's built-in **test job board**, because the machine that took the screenshots has no access to real job sites. Your copy, once hosted, fetches the real boards you list.

Part A: put it online (one time)

Where it runs: a free Hugging Face Space (2 CPUs, 16 GB of memory, no card needed). The app runs in a Docker container that already has the Chromium browser it needs to fill application forms.

Who can see your data: the web address is public, but every page needs your password. Your resume and details are stored encrypted inside the running container and nowhere else.

What to know first: the free Space keeps no disk. Everything you upload is **wiped when the Space restarts** (after 48 hours with no visits, or whenever you redeploy). Treat it as a test bench: export what you want to keep (Jobs page → Export CSV / JSON / HTML) and download tailored resumes from each job page.

A1. Get the code into a GitHub repository

1. On GitHub, create a new **private** repository, for example `job-applier`. Leave it empty (no README, no .gitignore).
2. Tell Claude the repository name. Claude pushes the code to it.

A2. Create the Space on Hugging Face

1. Sign up or log in at https://huggingface.co.
2. Open https://huggingface.co/new-space.
3. Fill in:
4. **Space name:** `job-applier`
5. **License:** leave as is
6. **Space SDK: Docker**, template **Blank**
7. **Space hardware: CPU basic · free**
8. **Visibility: Public** (the password below protects the app. A private Space blocks the app's own login cookie, so use Public.)
9. Press **Create Space**. It shows "No application file" for now. That is expected.

A3. Set your password (and optional Claude key) on the Space

In the Space, open **Settings** → **Variables and secrets** → **New secret**:

Name	Value	Needed?
`JOBAGENT_DASHBOARD_TOKEN`	A long password you make up (16+ characters). You type it to log in.	**Required.** The app refuses to start without it.
`ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`	Your Claude API key	Optional. Without it, cover letters and resume wording use plain templates built only from your resume.
`JOBAGENT_ENCRYPTION_KEY`	Leave unset	Optional. If unset, the app makes a key at startup and keeps it next to the data it protects.

A4. Connect GitHub to the Space

1. On Hugging Face: your avatar → **Settings** → **Access Tokens** → **Create new token** → type **Write** → name it `github-deploy` → **Create**. Copy the token (it starts with `hf_`).
2. On GitHub, in your `job-applier` repository: **Settings** → **Secrets and variables** → **Actions**.
3. **Secrets** tab → **New repository secret**: name `HF_TOKEN`, value the token you copied.
4. **Variables** tab → **New repository variable**: name `HF_SPACE`, value `<your-hf-username>/job-applier`.

A5. Deploy

1. In the GitHub repository, open **Actions** → **Deploy to Hugging Face Space** → **Run workflow**. From now on every push to the repository redeploys automatically.
2. Back on the Space page you see **Building** for 3 to 5 minutes, then **Running**.
3. Your app's address is **`https://<your-hf-username>-job-applier.hf.space`**. Open that address directly, not the huggingface.co/spaces page. The login cookie only works on the direct address.

If the Space shows **Runtime error**, open its **Logs** tab. The most common cause is a missing `JOBAGENT_DASHBOARD_TOKEN` secret. The log then says "Refusing to start".

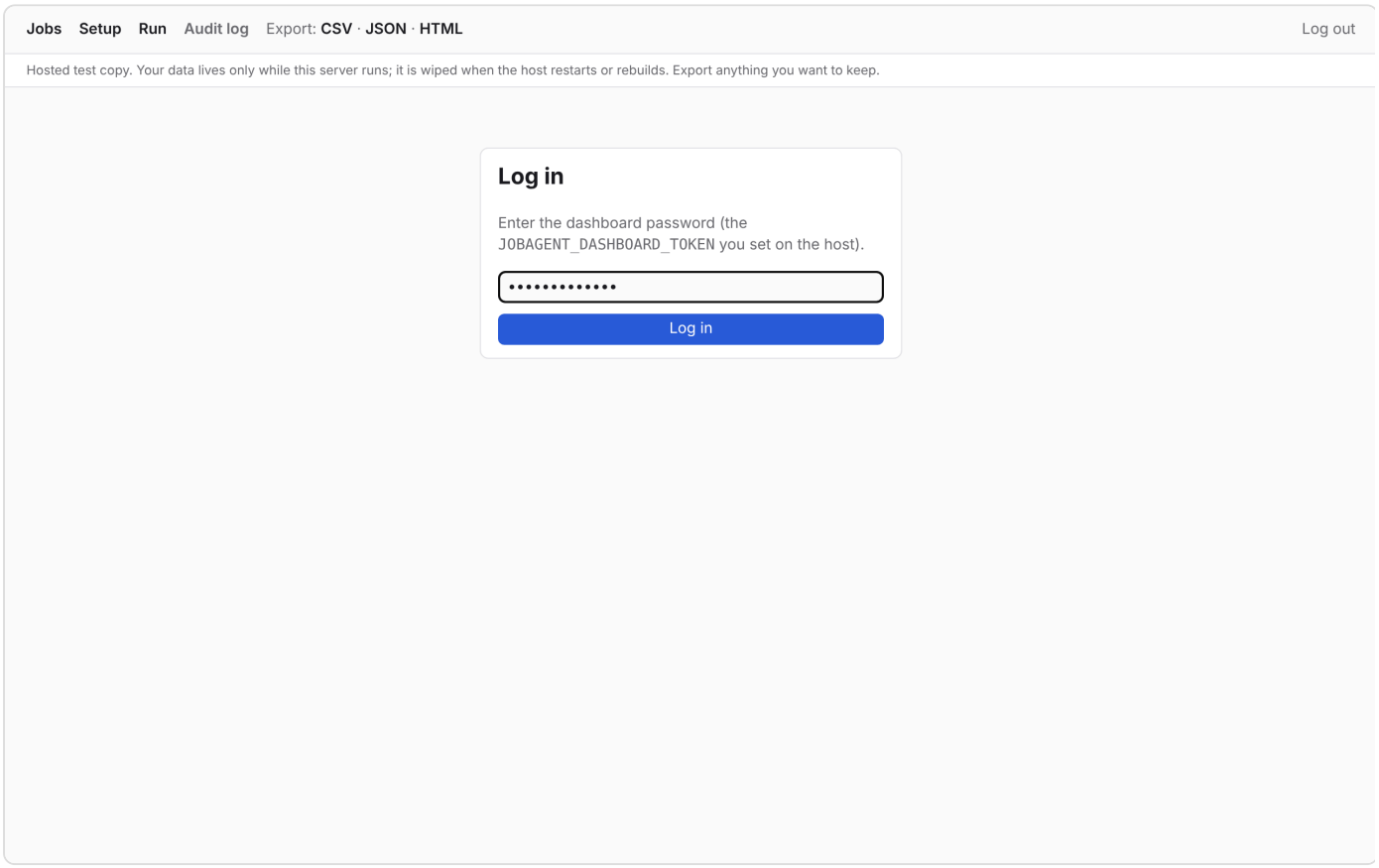
Alternative host: Render

The repository also contains `render.yaml`. On https://render.com: **New** → **Blueprint** → pick the repository → set `JOBAGENT_DASHBOARD_TOKEN` when asked. Render's free plan has 512 MB of memory and sleeps after 15 idle minutes, which also wipes your data, so Hugging Face is the better free choice.

Part B: use the app

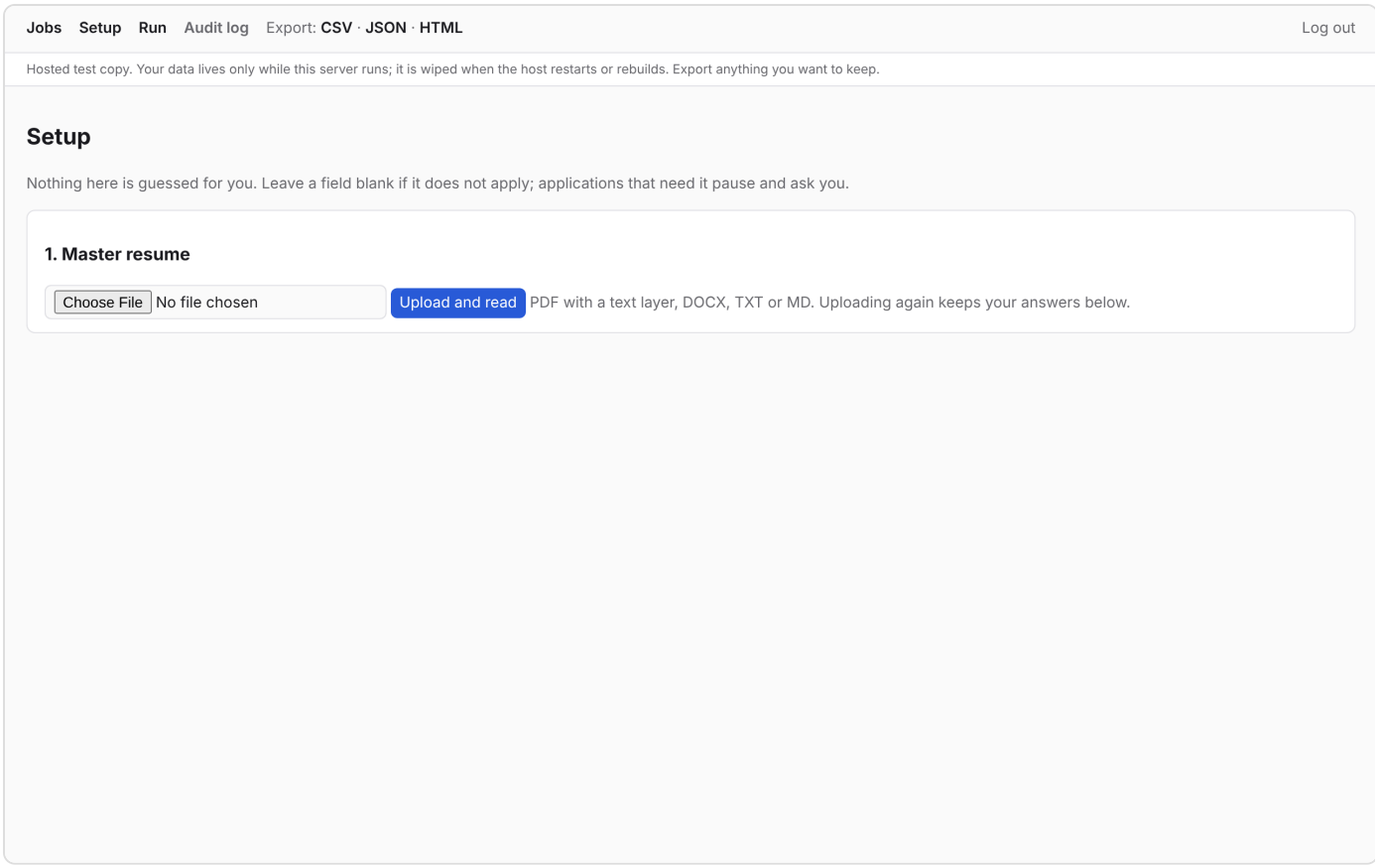
1. Log in

Open your Space address and type the password you set as `JOBAGENT_DASHBOARD_TOKEN`. You stay logged in on that browser for 30 days. **Log out** is at the top right.

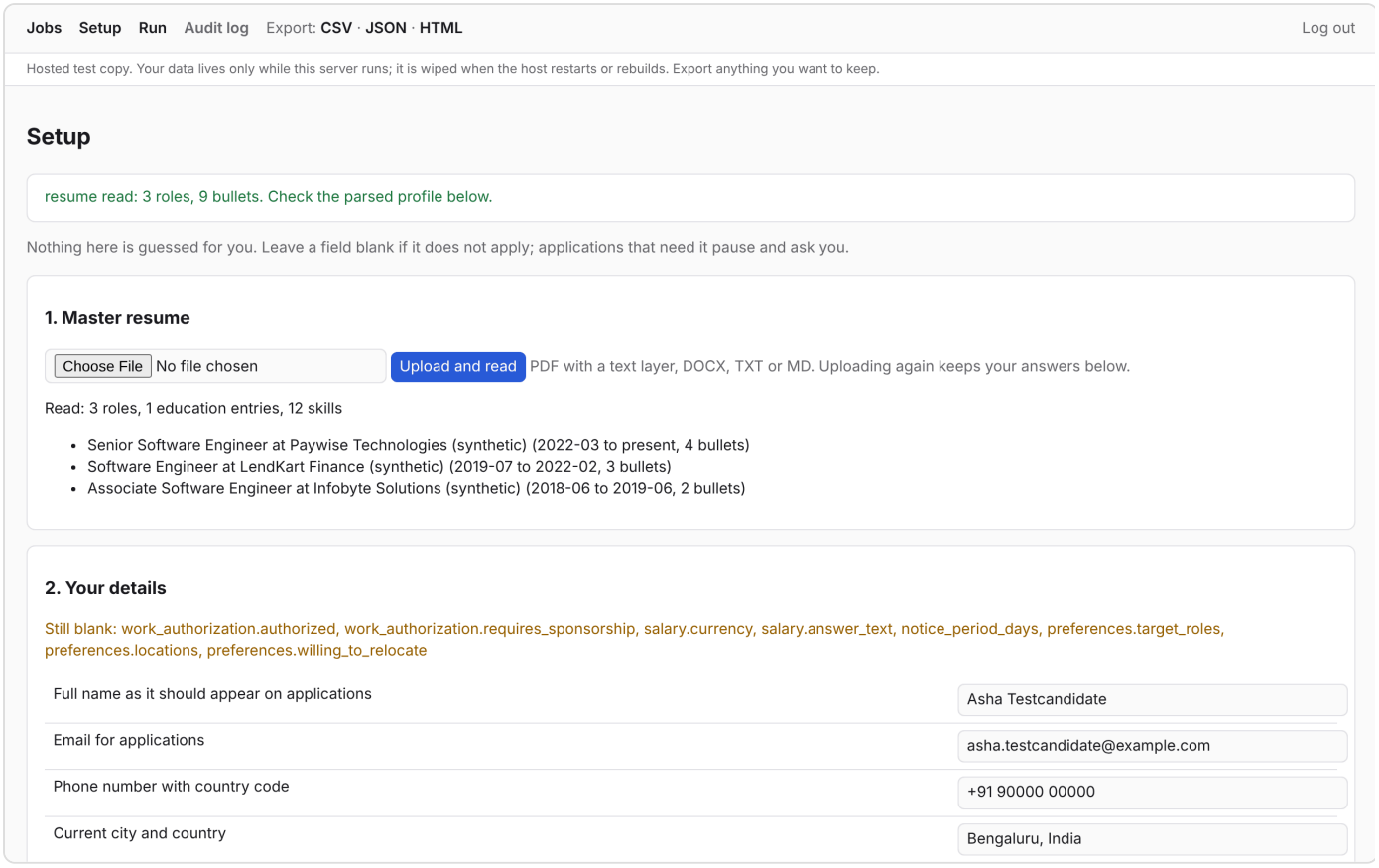


2. Upload your resume

You land on **Setup**. Under **1. Master resume**, press **Choose File**, pick your resume (PDF with selectable text, DOCX, TXT or MD), then press **Upload and read**.



The app shows what it read: each role with dates and number of bullets. **Check this list against your resume.** Parsing is heuristic. If a role is merged, split or missing, fix it in step 4.



Tip: a scanned PDF (an image of text) cannot be read. Export your resume from Word or Google Docs as PDF or DOCX.

3. Fill in your details, skill levels and job boards

2. Your details. Name, email, phone and LinkedIn come from your resume. The orange line lists what is still blank. Nothing is guessed: a blank field means applications that ask for it pause and ask you. Country fields use two-letter codes, for example `IN=citizen` and `IN=no, US=yes`.

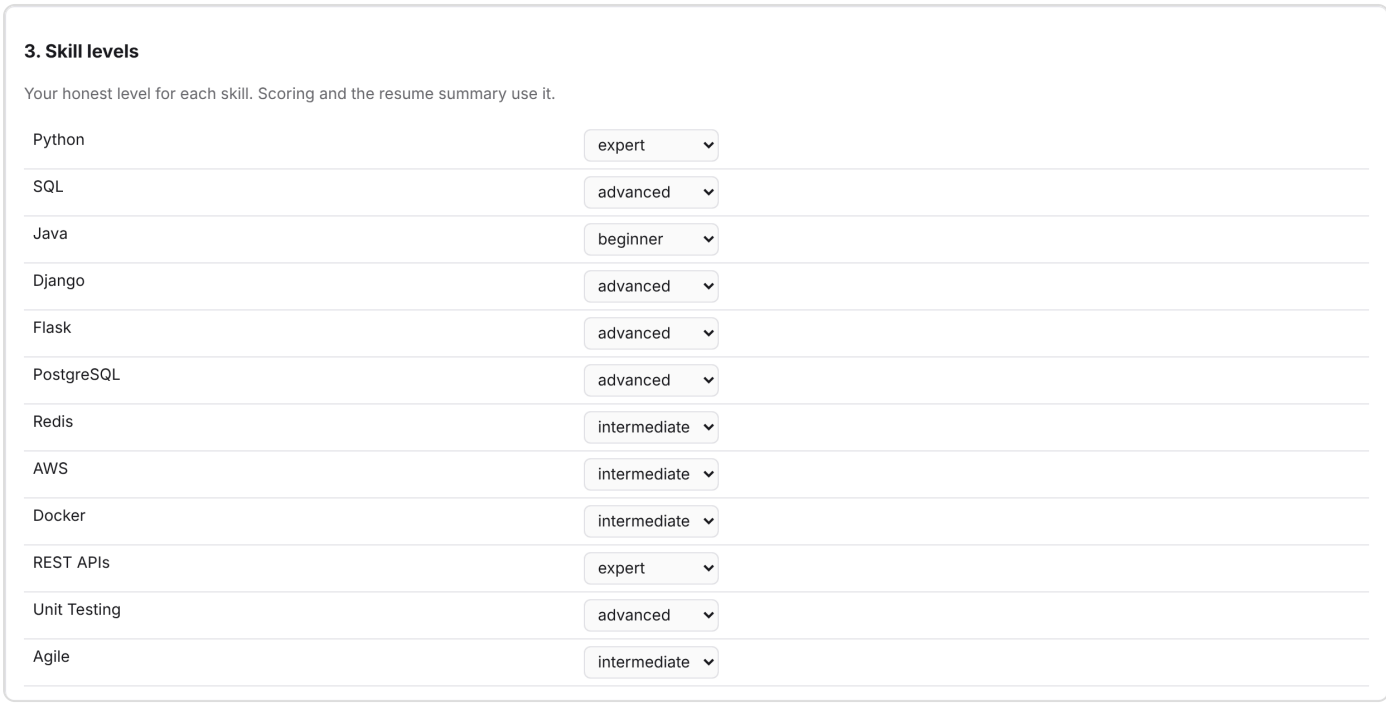
2. Your details

Still blank: work_authorization.authorized, work_authorization.requires_sponsorship, salary.currency, salary.answer_text, notice_period_days, preferences.target_roles, preferences.locations, preferences.willing_to_relocate

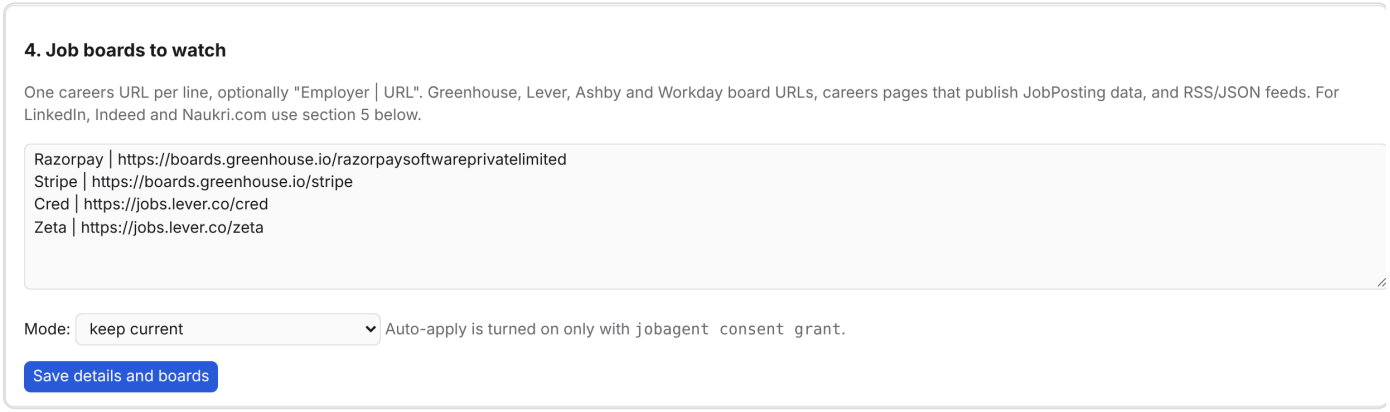
Full name as it should appear on applications	Asha Testcandidate
Email for applications	asha.testcandidate@example.com
Phone number with country code	+91 90000 00000
Current city and country	Bengaluru, India
LinkedIn URL (optional)	https://linkedin.com/in/asha-testcandidate-synthetic
GitHub URL (optional)	https://github.com/asha-testcandidate-synthetic
Countries where you can work without a new visa, with your status (e.g. IN=citizen, AE=resident)	IN=citizen
Do you need visa sponsorship, per country you would apply in? (e.g. IN=no, US=yes, GB=yes)	IN=no, US=yes, GB=yes
Salary currency (e.g. INR, USD)	INR
Expected salary per year, as a number (optional)	3800000
Minimum acceptable salary per year (optional, used only to skip jobs)	3000000
Exact wording to use when a form asks your salary expectation (e.g. 'Negotiable, 35-40 LPA')	Negotiable, 35-40 LPA
Notice period in days	60
Earliest start date YYYY-MM-DD (optional)	
Exact wording for 'current CTC / current salary' questions, which Naukri asks (optional, e.g. '24 LPA')	30 LPA
Target job titles, comma separated	Senior Backend Engineer, Senior Software Engineer,
Adjacent titles you would also consider (optional)	Platform Engineer
Locations you would work in, comma separated (e.g. Bengaluru, Remote India)	Bengaluru, Remote India
Work arrangements you accept: remote, hybrid, onsite	remote, hybrid, onsite
Willing to relocate? (yes/no)	no
Employment types (e.g. full-time, contract)	full-time
Employers to never apply to (optional)	
Skip jobs whose title mentions any of these (optional)	

Countries: two-letter codes, e.g. `IN=citizen` and `IN=no, US=yes`. Lists: comma separated. Yes/no fields: yes or no.

3. Skill levels. Give your honest level for each skill found on your resume. Scoring and the resume summary use it.



4. Job boards to watch. Paste company careers URLs, one per line, optionally as `Employer | URL`. Greenhouse (`boards.greenhouse.io/<company>`), Lever (`jobs.lever.co/<company>`), Ashby and Workday boards work, as do careers pages that publish job data and RSS/JSON feeds. Leave **Mode** on *discovery* for now. Press **Save details and boards**.



LinkedIn, Indeed and Naukri cannot be watched as boards (their terms forbid automated use). Section 5 of the Setup page explains the safe alternative: forward their alert emails or save job pages.

4. (If needed) correct the parsed profile

6. Check the parsed profile at the bottom of Setup is a text editor with everything the app knows about you. Fix titles, employers, dates or bullets here and press **Save profile**. You can also add true achievements that are not on your resume with `on_master_resume: false`. The app never invents experience; it only reorders and rewords what is here.

6. Check the parsed profile

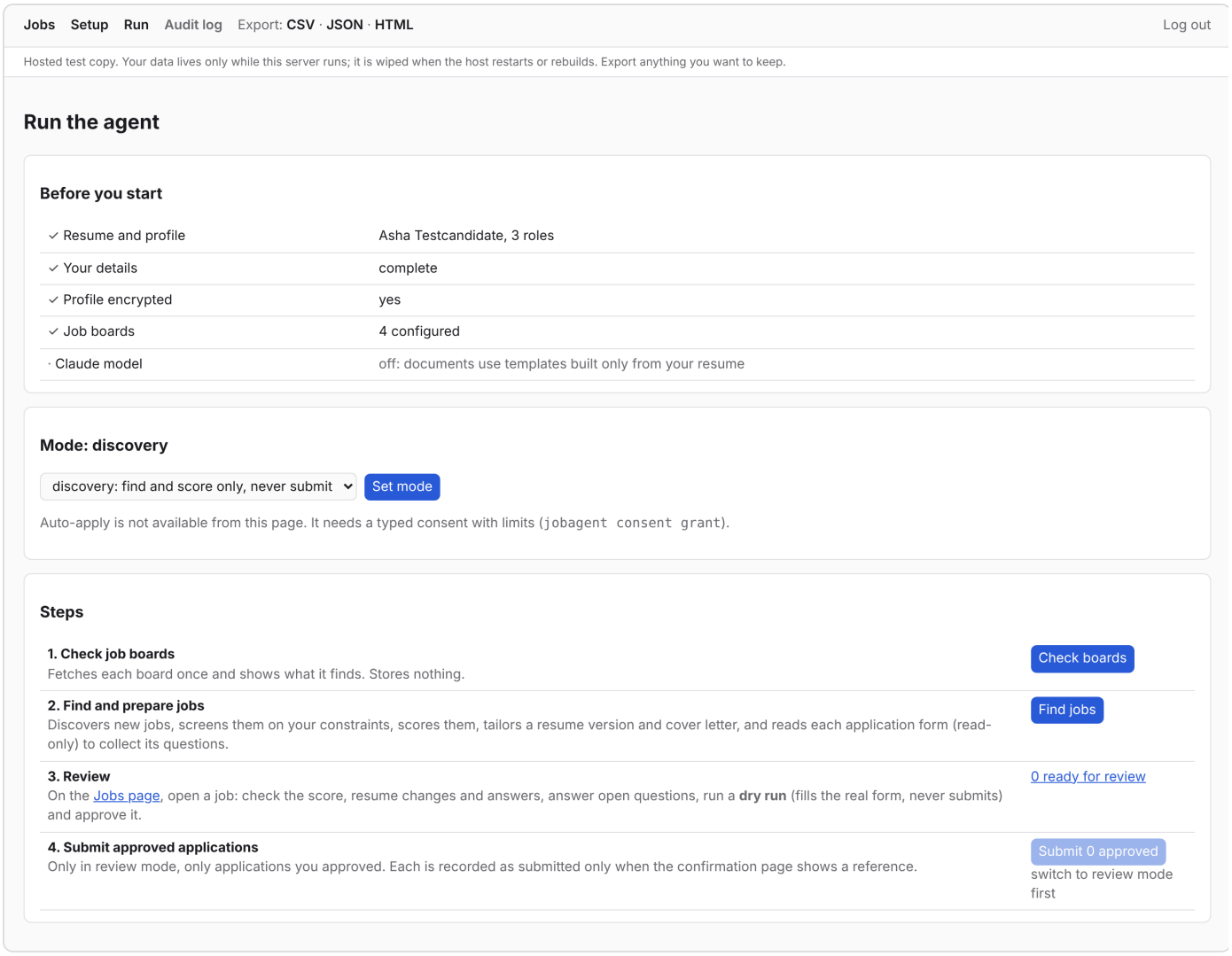
Resume parsing is heuristic. Fix titles, employers, dates and bullets here. Mark extra true achievements that are not on your resume with `on_master_resume: false`.

```
synthetic: false
contact:
  name: Asha Testcandidate
  email: asha.testcandidate@example.com
  phone: +91 90000 00000
  location: Bengaluru, India
  linkedin: https://linkedin.com/in/asha-testcandidate-synthetic
  github: https://github.com/asha-testcandidate-synthetic
  website: null
summary: SYNTHETIC TEST DATA. Backend engineer with eight years of experience building
  payment and lending services in Python.
experience:
- id: exp1
  employer: Paywise Technologies (synthetic)
  title: Senior Software Engineer
  start: 2022-03
  end: null
  location: Bengaluru, India
  domains:
  - payments
  bullets:
  - id: exp1.b1
    text: Designed and built REST APIs in Django for merchant onboarding used by 12,000
      merchants.
    on_master_resume: true
  - id: exp1.b2
    text: Reduced payment reconciliation time by 35% by rewriting batch jobs with
      PostgreSQL window functions.
    on_master_resume: true
  - id: exp1.b3
```

Save profile

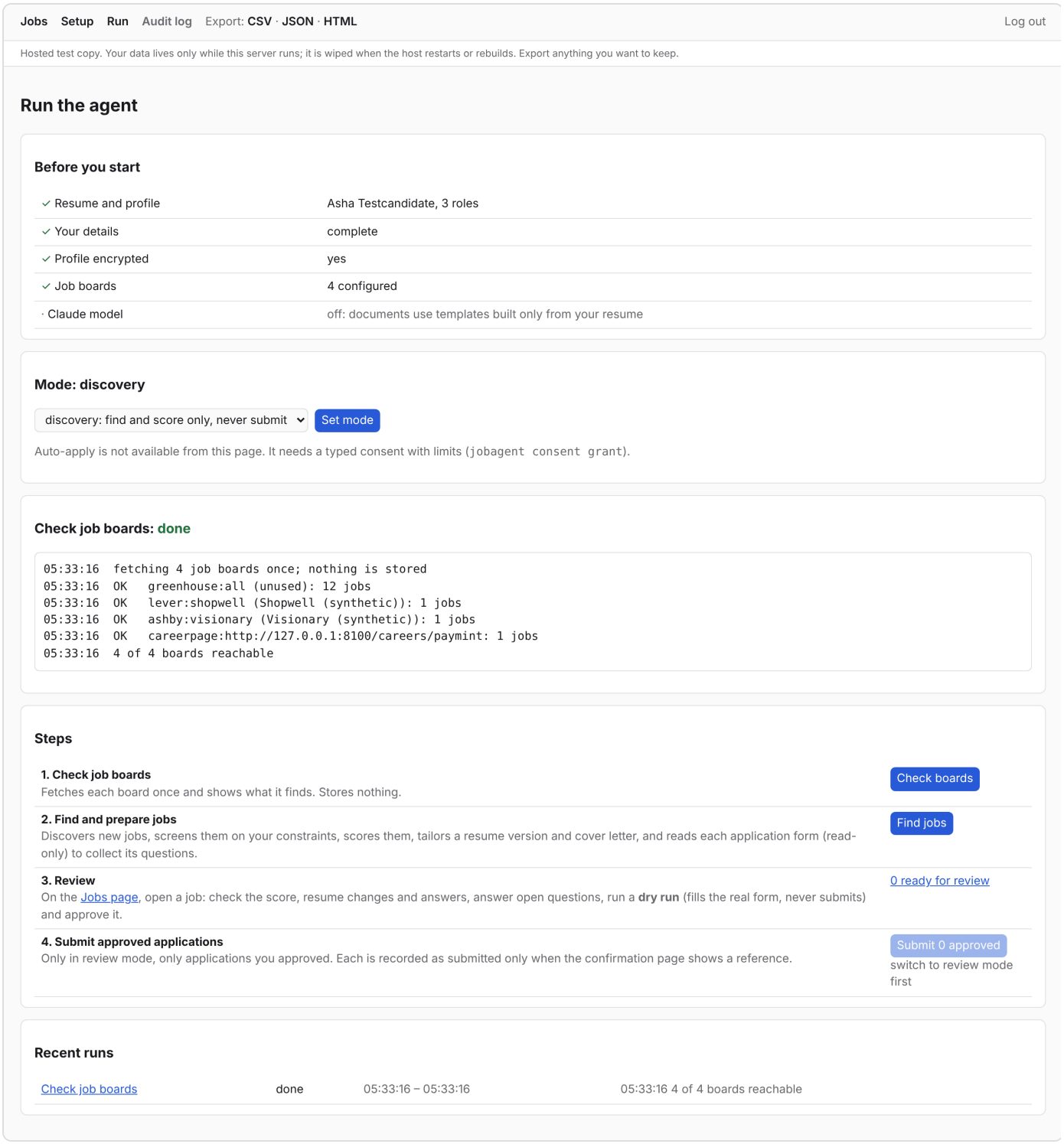
5. Check your setup on the Run page

Open **Run**. **Before you start** should show green ticks for resume, details, encryption and boards.

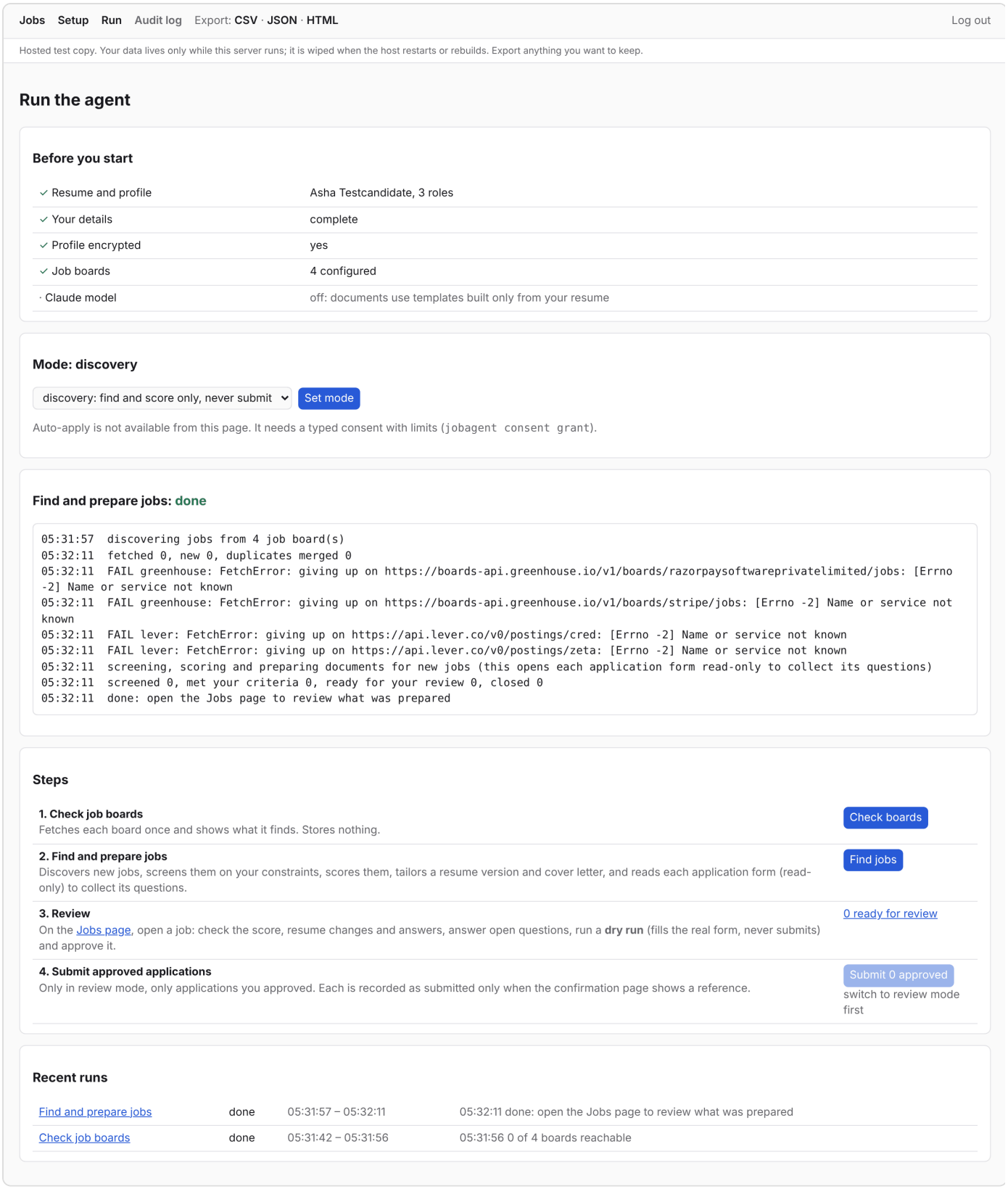


6. Check job boards

Press **Check boards**. Each board is fetched once and nothing is stored. Each line says OK with a job count, or FAIL with the reason. Fix or remove failing boards on Setup before going on.

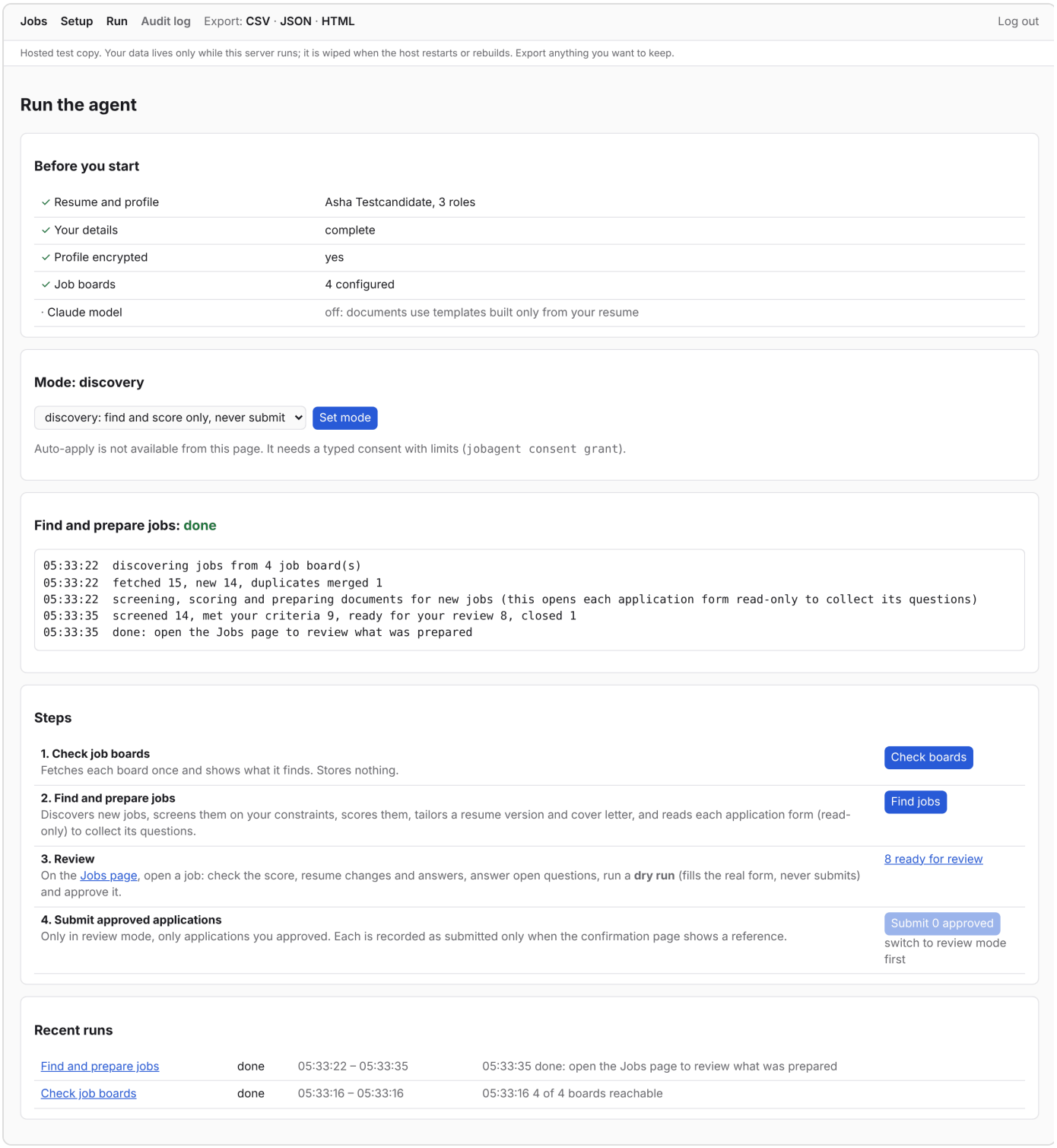


If every board fails with "Name or service not known" or a timeout, the server cannot reach the job sites. This is what that looks like:



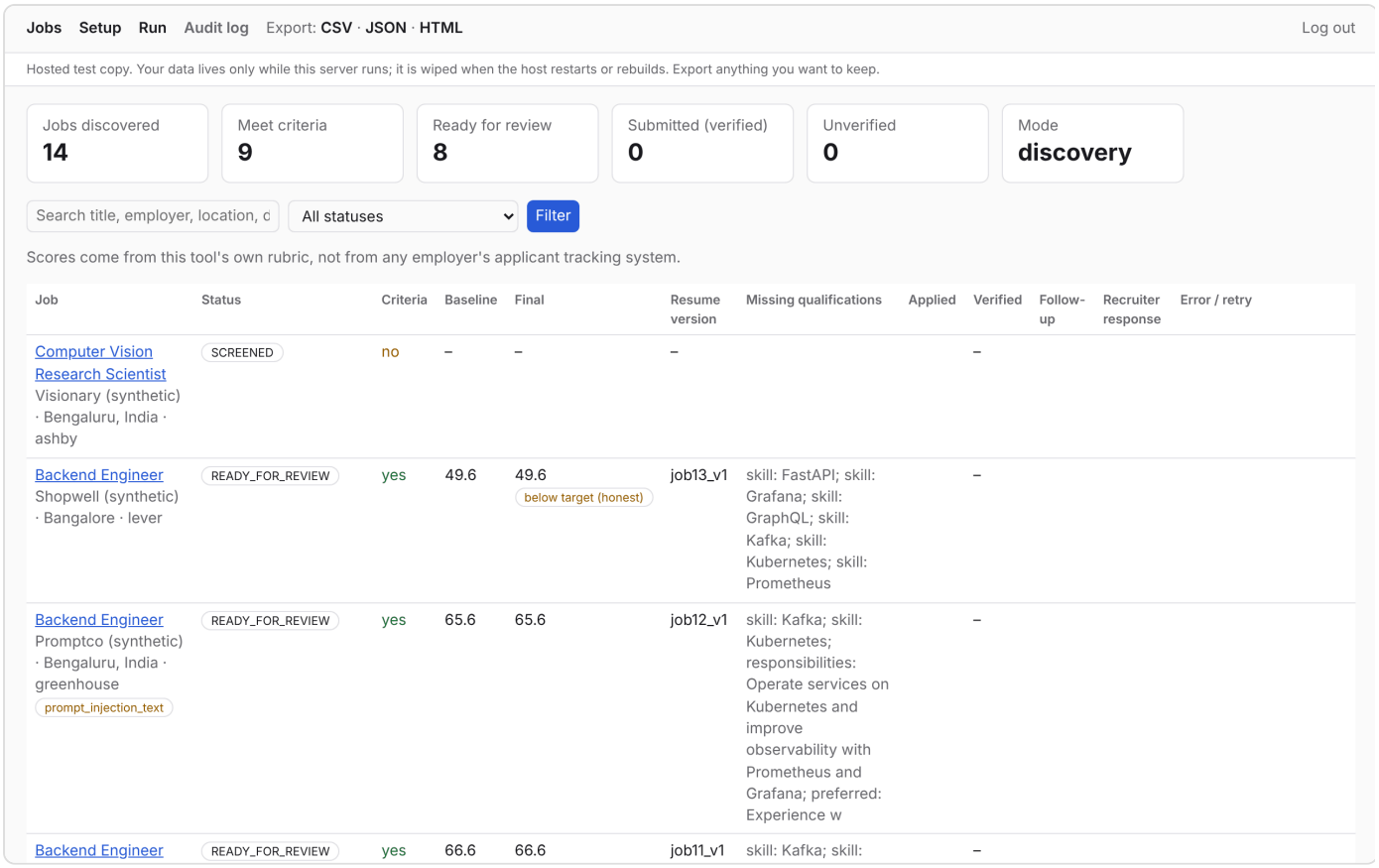
7. Find and prepare jobs

Press **Find jobs**. The live log shows each stage. The app finds new jobs, drops those that break your hard constraints (location, sponsorship, salary floor, excluded employers), scores the rest against your resume, makes a tailored resume and cover letter for each, and opens each application form read-only to list its questions. With 10 to 20 jobs this takes about a minute. Only one run happens at a time.

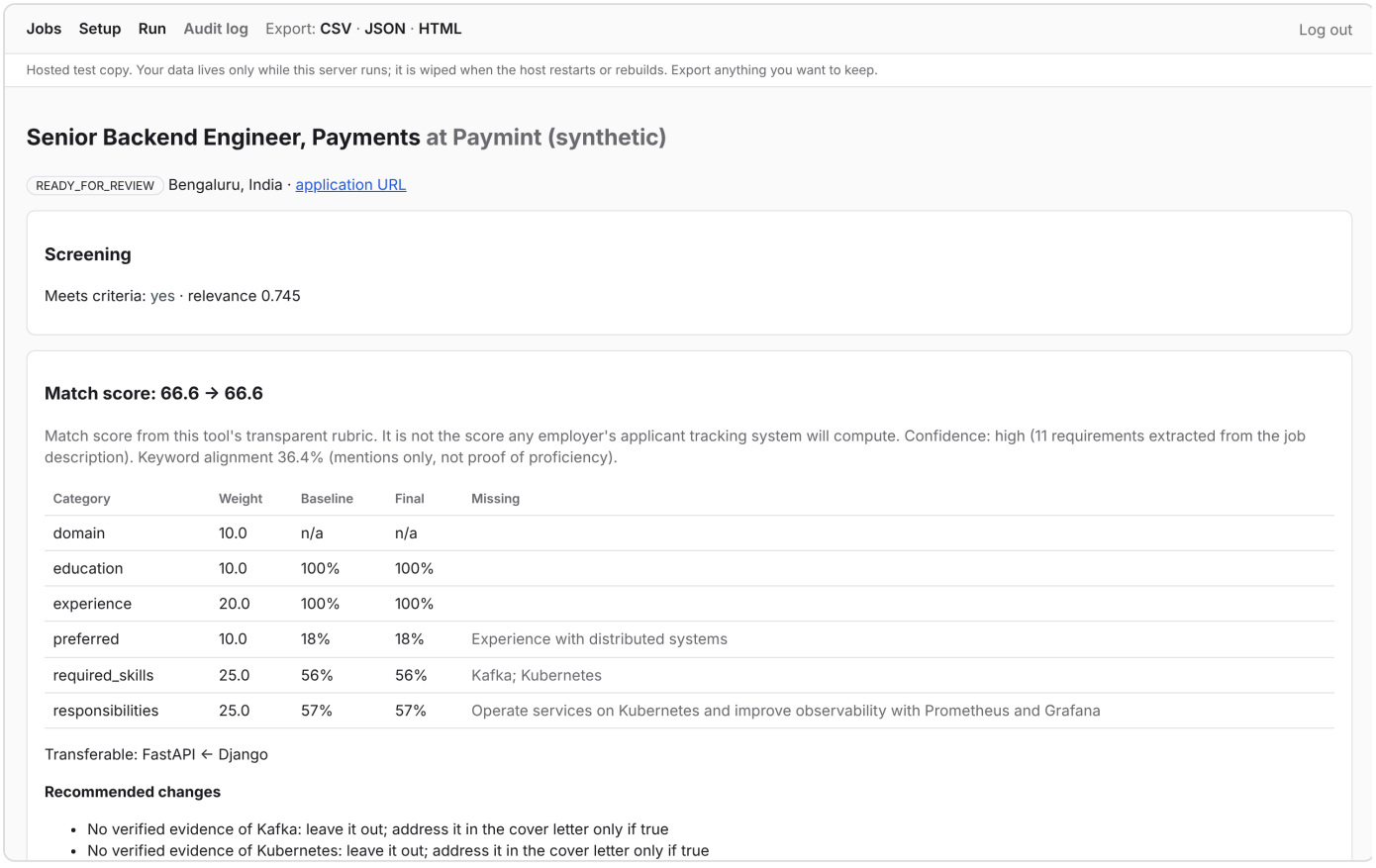


8. Review the jobs

Open **Jobs**. Each row shows the status, whether it meets your criteria, the score before and after tailoring, and the missing qualifications. Warnings such as *CAPTCHA present* or *page does not match* appear under the status. The score is this tool's own rubric, not what the employer's system computes.



Click a job title to open it.



Match score: the score per category, what is missing, and transferable skills.

Match score: 66.6 → 66.6

Match score from this tool's transparent rubric. It is not the score any employer's applicant tracking system will compute. Confidence: high (11 requirements extracted from the job description). Keyword alignment 36.4% (mentions only, not proof of proficiency).

Category	Weight	Baseline	Final	Missing
domain	10.0	n/a	n/a	
education	10.0	100%	100%	
experience	20.0	100%	100%	
preferred	10.0	18%	18%	Experience with distributed systems
required_skills	25.0	56%	56%	Kafka; Kubernetes
responsibilities	25.0	57%	57%	Operate services on Kubernetes and improve observability with Prometheus and Grafana

Transferable: FastAPI ← Django

Recommended changes

- No verified evidence of Kafka: leave it out; address it in the cover letter only if true
- No verified evidence of Kubernetes: leave it out; address it in the cover letter only if true

▶ Evidence per category

Resume changes: exactly what was changed for this job (reordered bullets, skills first) and the gaps it did not paper over. The tailored resume and cover letter download from the **Files** links (DOCX, PDF, TXT).

Resume changes (not_required)

- **reorder_bullets** exp1: most relevant evidence first
  before: exp1.b1, exp1.b2, exp1.b3, exp1.b4
  after: exp1.b3, exp1.b1, exp1.b2, exp1.b4
- **reorder_skills** skills: requested skills first
  before: Python, SQL, Java, Django, Flask, PostgreSQL, Redis, AWS, Docker, REST APIs, Unit Testing, Agile
  after: Python, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, Django, Flask, SQL, Java, AWS, REST APIs, Unit Testing, Agile

Remaining gaps

- skill: Kafka
- skill: Kubernetes
- responsibilities: Operate services on Kubernetes and improve observability with Prometheus and Grafana
- preferred: Experience with distributed systems

Files: cover_letter_docx cover_letter_txt docx html pdf txt

▶ Tailored resume text
▶ Cover letter

Application answers: every question on the employer's form, the answer the app will give, and where the answer came from. Questions it must not answer for you (such as gender) show a dropdown. Pick your answer and press **Save answer**.

Application answers

Question	Answer	Status	Source
Are you legally authorized to work in India? *	Yes	answered	work_authorization.authorized.IN citizen
Cover Letter		file	documents
Email *	asha.testcandidate@example.com	answered	contact.email
First Name *	Asha	answered	contact.name
Gender	Prefer not to say	answered	candidate provided by candidate
Last Name *	Testcandidate	answered	contact.name
LinkedIn Profile	https://linkedin.com/in/asha-testcandidate-synthetic	answered	contact.linkedin
Phone *	+91 90000 00000	answered	contact.phone
Resume/CV *		file	documents
What are your salary expectations? *	Negotiable, 35-40 LPA	answered	salary.answer_text
What is your notice period? *	60 days	answered	notice_period_days
Will you now or in the future require visa sponsorship to work in India? *	No	answered	work_authorization.requires_sponsorship.IN

Dry run (never submits) Approve documents and answers

9. Dry run, then approve

Press **Dry run (never submits)**. The app opens the real application form, fills every field, uploads the resume and cover letter, takes a screenshot, and stops before submitting. Any request that could send data is blocked.

Dry run (job 1): done

```
05:34:45  opening the real application page for job 1 read-only; nothing will be submitted
05:34:46  ready_to_submit: every required field is filled; submit was NOT clicked
05:34:46    filled: First Name = Asha
05:34:46    filled: Last Name = Testcandidate
05:34:46    filled: Email = asha.testcandidate@example.com
05:34:46    filled: Phone = +91 90000 00000
05:34:46    uploaded: Resume/CV = resume_job1_v1.docx
05:34:46    uploaded: Cover Letter = cover_letter_job1_v1.docx
05:34:46    filled: LinkedIn Profile = https://linkedin.com/in/asha-testcandidate-synthetic
05:34:46    filled: Are you legally authorized to work in India? = Yes
05:34:46    filled: Will you now or in the future require visa sponsorship to work in India? = No
05:34:46    filled: What is your notice period? = 60 days
05:34:46    filled: What are your salary expectations? = Negotiable, 35-40 LPA
05:34:46    filled: Gender = Prefer not to say
05:34:46  requests blocked because they could send data: 0. Nothing was submitted.
```

The **Last dry run** box lists every field and what was put in it. Open **Screenshot of the filled form** to see the page itself. When it looks right, press **Approve documents and answers**.

Last dry run (20261111T053504): ready_to_submit

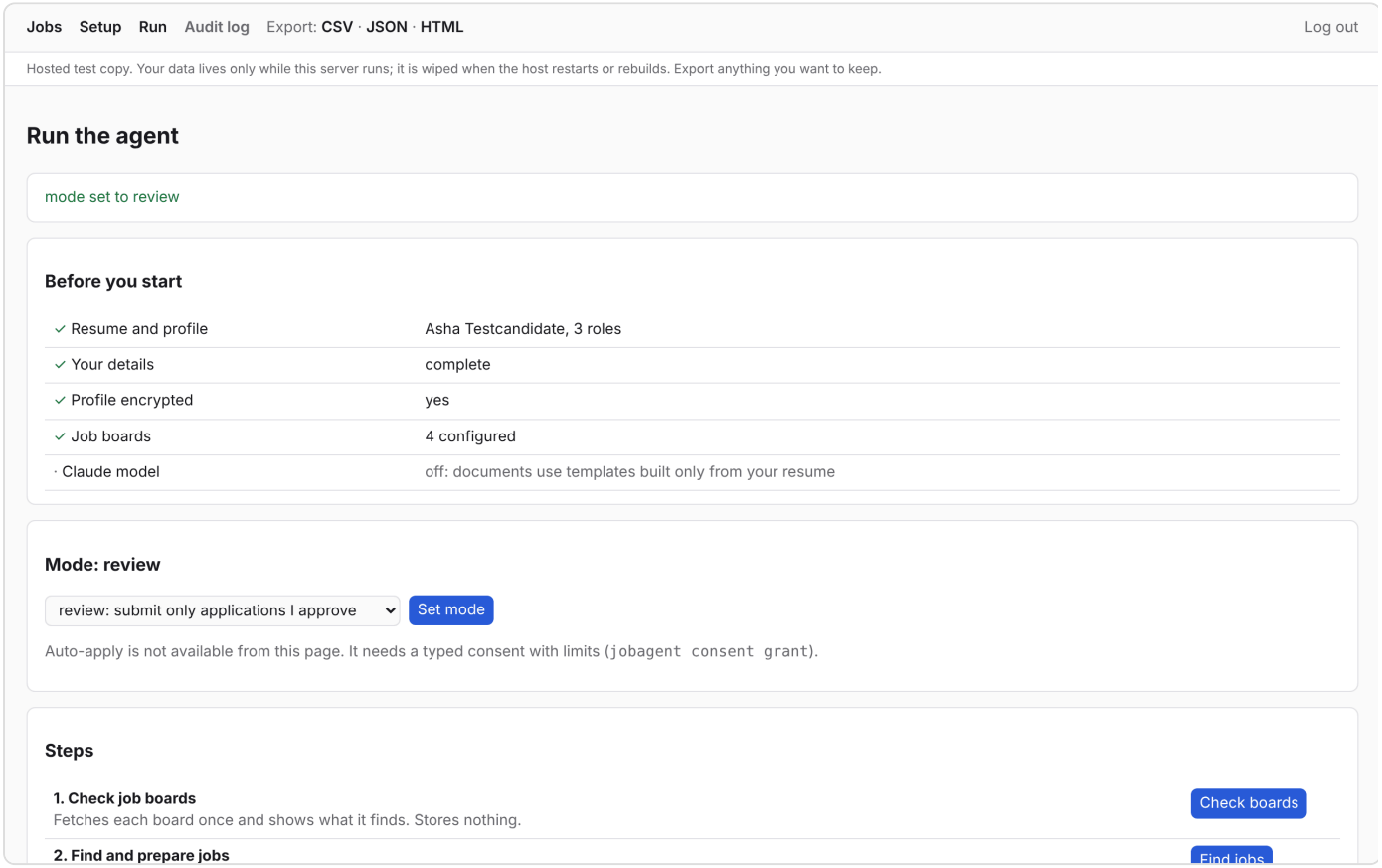
every required field is filled; submit was NOT clicked. Nothing was submitted; 0 requests that could send data were blocked.

Field	What happened	Value
First Name	filled	Asha
Last Name	filled	Testcandidate
Email	filled	asha.testcandidate@example.com
Phone	filled	+91 90000 00000
Resume/CV	uploaded	resume_job1_v1.docx
Cover Letter	uploaded	cover_letter_job1_v1.docx
LinkedIn Profile	filled	https://linkedin.com/in/asha-testcandidate-synthetic
Are you legally authorized to work in India?	filled	Yes
Will you now or in the future require visa sponsorship to work in India?	filled	No
What is your notice period?	filled	60 days
What are your salary expectations?	filled	Negotiable, 35-40 LPA
Gender	filled	Prefer not to say

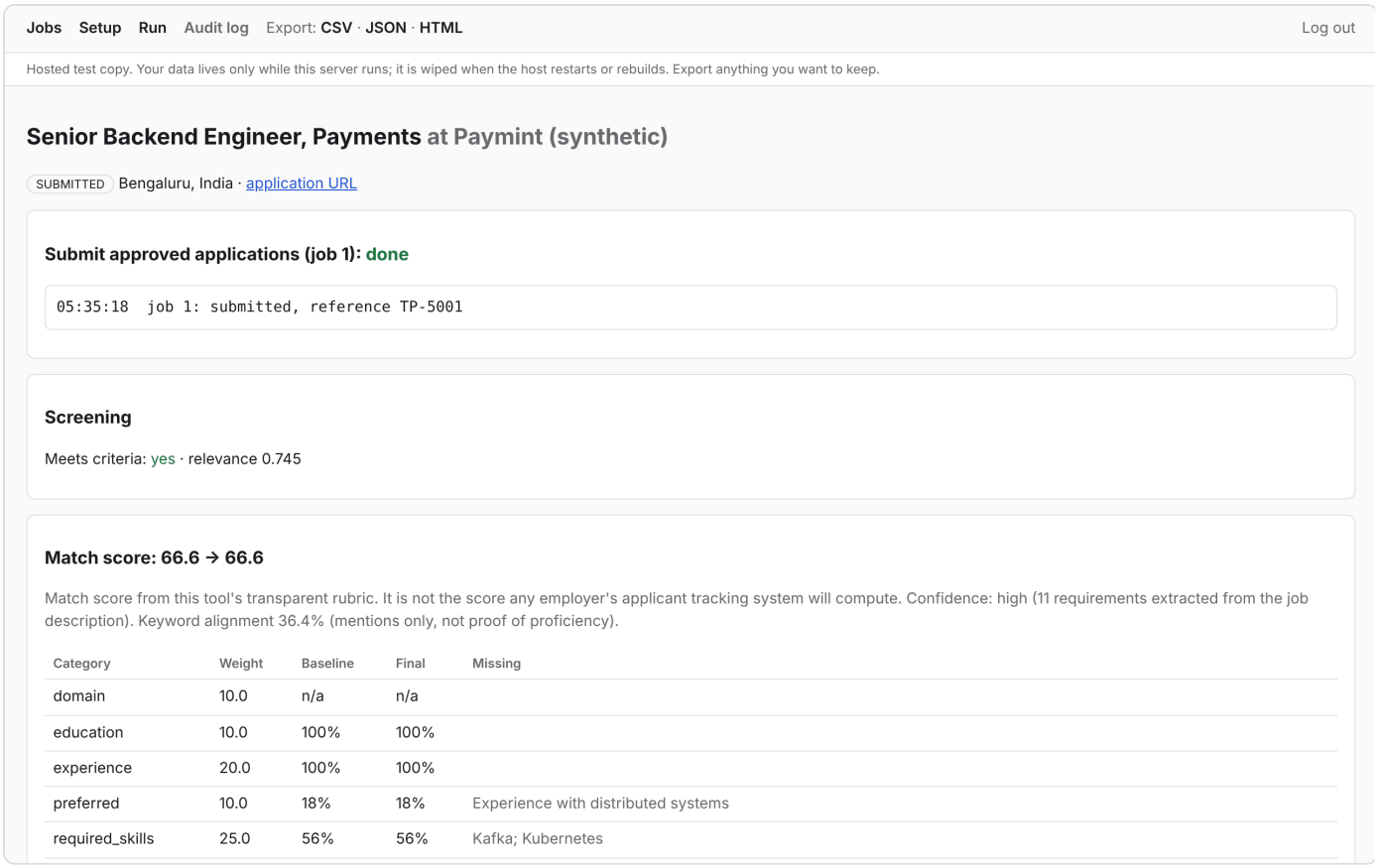
▶ Screenshot of the filled form

10. Submit

Submitting is off until you allow it. On **Run**, choose **review: submit only applications I approve** and press **Set mode**.



Then press **Submit** on an approved job's page (it asks you to confirm), or **Submit N approved** on the Run page. A job counts as **SUBMITTED** only when the employer's confirmation page shows a reference number. Otherwise it is marked *SUBMISSION_UNVERIFIED* for you to check.



Start with one job. Use your real resume, dry-run one real posting, read the filled form screenshot carefully, and only then submit one. The Greenhouse and Lever form fillers have been tested on the test board and on real posting data, but not yet by submitting to a real employer.

11. Keep your results

The free Space wipes its data on restart. Before you leave:

- **Export** (top bar): CSV, JSON or HTML of every job and status.
- On each job page, download the tailored resume and cover letter from **Files**.
- **Audit log** (top bar) records every action the app took.

Quick reference

I want to...	Go to
Change my details or boards	Setup → sections 2–4 → Save details and boards
Fix what the resume parser read	Setup → section 6 → Save profile
Find new jobs	Run → Find jobs
See why a job was skipped	Jobs → click the job → Screening

I want to…	Go to
Fill a form without sending it	Job page → Dry run (never submits)
Allow submissions	Run → Mode: review → Set mode
Stop submissions	Run → Mode: discovery → Set mode
Turn on Claude-written wording	Space Settings → add secret `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` → the Space restarts (data is wiped)